

Glossary



agriculture

Growing crops and raising livestock for food

ally

Country that supports another country and might agree to trade deals or to fight alongside it in a war

ancient

Very old

army

Organized group of soldiers

artifact

Human-made object, generally of historic or cultural interest, such as a painting or a vase

astronaut

Someone who is trained to travel and work in a spacecraft

BCE

Before Common Era, or all the years before year 1

beliefs

Set of views that people hold about the world, life, and the afterlife

Buddhist

Member of a religion called Buddhism, which follows the teachings of the Buddha, who lived in India about 2,500 years ago

capitalism

Political or economic system where individuals own property and companies, instead of the government owning them

CE

Common Era, or all the years after year 1

Christian

Someone who follows the religious teachings of Jesus Christ, who lived in the Middle East 2,000 years ago

civilization

Society where people have built a complex city or country

colony

Area of land or island belonging to a different country

conquer

Act of one country taking over another country

culture

Way of life and beliefs of the people of a region or country

democracy

System of government where people outside the government have a say in how the country is run, usually by voting

dictator

Ruler with total power

emperor

Ruler of an empire

empire

Large area with different peoples, ruled by a king/queen or emperor/empress

government

Group of people who run a country

Hindu

Member of the Indian religion Hinduism. Hindus worship many gods and believe that when people die they are born again

holy

Something or somewhere sacred to a religion

independence

Freedom from outside control, such as when a country or area is no longer ruled by another country

Jew

Follower of the religion Judaism. Jews worship one God and their holy books are the Hebrew Bible (Old Testament) and the Talmud

Muslim

Someone whose religion is Islam. Muslims believe in one God, and they follow the teachings of the Prophet Muhammad

native

Person linked to a place by birth, or who is descended from the original inhabitants of an area

Nazi

Member, or follower, of the Nazi Party (National Socialists) in Germany, led by Adolf Hitler

peasant

A poor person whose way of life is dependent on farming

persecution

Bad treatment of people because of their beliefs

Renaissance

A focus on art and learning in Europe that began in the 15th century, linked to a renewed interest in the ancient cultures of Greece and Rome

revolution

Sudden change that happens when a government or ruling power is overthrown, often quickly and by force

slave

Person who is forced to work for or serve another person or family. Slaves are considered the property of their owners and forced to obey them

society

Organized group of people with a shared culture

spy

Person who gathers information in secret. In war, each side uses spies to find out the other's secrets

technology

Using scientific knowledge to create machinery and devices, such as computers

territory

Area of land that belongs to a particular country or state

trade route

Route traveled by merchants carrying goods from one country to another

traditional

When something has been done in the same way for a long time

tribe

Group of people who share the same culture and history. It usually refers to people who live together in traditional communities, far from cities and towns